

INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Product/Services Management

BUYING AND MERCHANDISING
TEAM DECISION MAKING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 30 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 15 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature and scope of the product/service management function.
2. Explain the concept of product mix.
3. Explain the nature of product/service branding.
4. Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services.
5. Generate product ideas.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the roles of the product development manager and the marketing communications manager for ARTISAN CRAFTS, a company that specializes in handmade home décor and personalized gifts. The CEO (judge) has tasked your team with exploring the potential for a subscription box service featuring curated artisan products.

ARTISAN CRAFTS has built a strong brand around its unique, handcrafted items, which include home décor, candles, and custom-made gifts. Recently, the subscription box trend has gained traction, and the CEO believes that offering a monthly subscription box could tap into a new customer base while providing an ongoing revenue stream.

Your team needs to evaluate the following:

- How would introducing a subscription box service fit into ARTISAN CRAFTS' existing product line?
- What types of products should be included in the subscription box to appeal to the target audience?
- What marketing strategies can be employed to launch the subscription box successfully and attract subscribers?
- What potential challenges might arise from managing a subscription service, and how can these challenges be addressed?

You will present your analysis and recommendations to the CEO (judge) in a meeting to take place in the CEO’s (judge’s) office. The CEO (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered the CEO’s (judge’s) questions, the CEO (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Potential Judge's Questions:

1. What are the key challenges you anticipate in the logistics and supply chain management of the subscription box service?
2. How do you intend to differentiate your subscription box from competitors?

Rate the participants' ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature and scope of the product/service management function.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Explain the concept of product mix.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Explain the nature of product/service branding.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Generate product ideas.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	